Day 56 - River Kwai, Bayview Escarpment, Kaboom

Bruce Trail side-trail plan (dog-friendly, max ~8 mi) · Sydenham section · hike 69 · Bayview Escarpment Provincial Nature Reserve

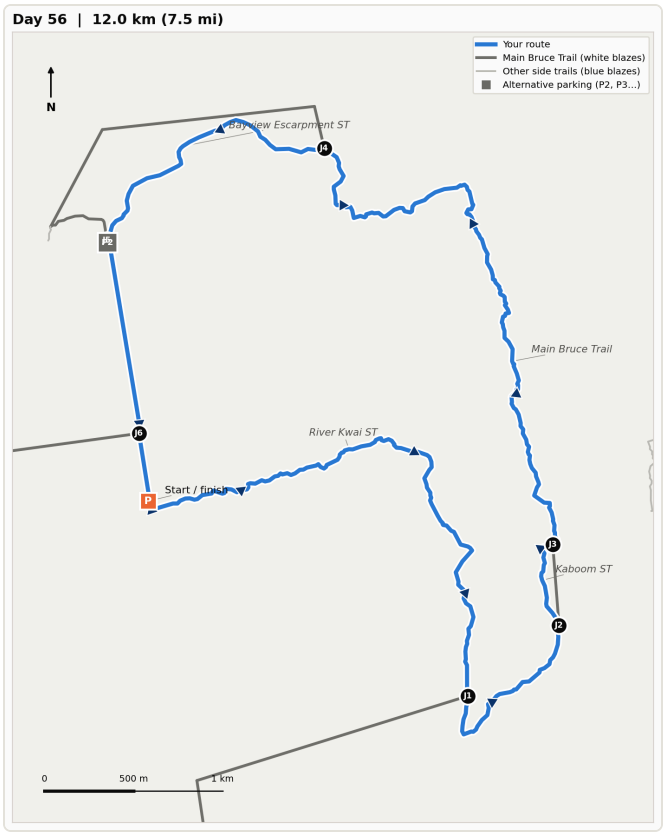
12.0 km / 7.5 mi	~3.8 h	6.1 km new	150 min
total walking	hiking, plus stops	side trail covered	drive each way, Sat 7 am

Park (P): Bayview Escarpment Provincial Nature Reserve (south): roadside parking along the St. Vincent-Sydenham Townline at the field entrance to the River Kwai Side Trail. Google Maps. **Free · book ahead**

Navigate: import *day56_hike069.gpx* into Gaia GPS. The track is the whole route in walking order, and the J waypoints match the directions below.

Side trails covered: River Kwai Side Trail (3.9 km); Bayview Escarpment Side Trail (1.7 km); Kaboom Side Trail (0.6 km)

Route map



What to expect

- **Parking:** Roadside along the St. Vincent-Sydenham Townline at the field entrance to the River Kwai Side Trail. The reserve has no visitor facilities, so bring water and plan for the full 12 km.
- **River Kwai Side Trail:** Hikers describe crossing an old logging road, walking about 1.5 km through hardwood forest, then crossing a field and the River Kwai Bridge.
- **Bayview Escarpment:** A dolostone-capped promontory with nearly 8 km of sensitive slopes and cliffs, crevice caves, exposed bedrock, fern colonies including rare species, and a swamp at the base. Ontario Parks asks visitors to tread lightly.
- **Main Trail along the edge:** About 2.5 km follows the scarp edge through cedar and hardwood, with broad views over the Meaford Tank Range to Georgian Bay and Collingwood. The footing is broken dolostone cobbles and old cart tracks, and one writer called parts of the cliff edge “perilous”. Keep Zappy close.
- **Military neighbour:** The reserve borders the Meaford Land Forces Training Centre. Fences carry “No Trespassing” signs, and you may hear or see tank manoeuvres. Stay on the trail.
- **Kaboom & Bayview Escarpment side trails:** Short spurs off the Main Trail. We found no published description of either.
- **Road walking:** The last part of the route follows a road shoulder on the Main Trail and then the River Kwai Side Trail (trip reports place this on the St. Vincent-Sydenham Townline). Keep Zappy close.

Parking options

	Alternative parking	Parking cost	Route km	Walk to trail	Closest side trails
P2	Bayview Escarpment Provincial Nature Reserve (north): Off road parking along the St map	Free · book ahead	10.6	0 m	Bayview Escarpment

Parking costs were checked in October 2026 from operator websites and Bruce Trail Conservancy data; prices and booking rules change, so check before you go.

Turn-by-turn

km	mi	Directions
0.0	0.0	Start at the parking: Bayview Escarpment Provincial Nature Reserve (south): roadside parking along the St. Walk about 50 m to the trail. Head east on the blue-blazed River Kwai Side Trail.
3.4	2.1	J1: Continue straight onto the white-blazed main Bruce Trail, heading south. (the white-blazed main Bruce Trail goes off on your right.)
4.6	2.8	J2: Turn left onto the blue-blazed Kaboom Side Trail, heading north-west. (the white-blazed main Bruce Trail goes off ahead.)
5.1	3.2	J3: Continue straight onto the white-blazed main Bruce Trail, heading north-east. (the white-blazed main Bruce Trail goes off on your right.)

8.8	5.4	J4: Continue straight onto the blue-blazed Bayview Escarpment Side Trail, heading west. (the white-blazed main Bruce Trail goes off on your right.)
10.4	6.5	J5: Turn left onto the white-blazed main Bruce Trail, heading south. (the white-blazed main Bruce Trail goes off on your right.) The next 0.0 km follows an unopened road allowance (rough track, no traffic).
10.5	6.5	Heads-up: The next 1.5 km follows a road shoulder; keep the dog close.
11.5	7.2	J6: Continue straight onto the blue-blazed River Kwai Side Trail, heading south. (the white-blazed main Bruce Trail goes off on your right.)
12.0	7.5	Leave the trail and walk back to the parking. Hike complete.

Distances and junctions are computed from the Bruce Trail Conservancy's trail data (Bruce County GIS). Left/right is calculated from the trail geometry. Use it as a guide, follow the blazes, and check the Conservancy's trail-change notices before you go. Dogs must be leashed everywhere on the Bruce Trail. Trail descriptions draw on Ontario Parks, the Sydenham Bruce Trail Club, Niagara Escarpment Views and a hiker's trip report.